What if the required sum did not materialize? The company would have to be liquidated and the only result would be the lessons learnt. What were these lessons? Firstly, blame was assigned to the original management for SSNCo's current troubles. The promoters 'had bought the steamers without capital on hand', tempted by 'the modern facility of making purchases by prepayment of a fractional share of the purchase money'. Operations were started without sufficient working capital. The flow of capital, though not bad initially, was never in time, forcing heavy borrowing to make the payments of the instalments, with the result that 'the financial position of the company was throughout one of unpreparedness. Capital collected out of time was not a third as serviceable to us as it would have been if it had come in time'. Their advice to future promoters: 'Do not purchase, do not start business' without adequate capital to purchase steamers, and sufficient working capital to meet the first few years of competition.[66]

Finally, the directors made the following plea: 'Do not let such a big catastrophe happen! Each one of you should double your investment.' Confessing their 'many blunders and shortcomings' to the general public, the directors nevertheless underlined their struggles prompted by 'a noble zeal for the public good' and 'the disinterested efforts and heavy sacrifices' made for the cause.

There was some heartening news after these meetings. S.D. Krishna Aiyangar left for Colombo with Rs 26,000 to retrieve the ships and arrange for the coastal service.[67] Meanwhile there was unconfirmed news that C. Vijayaraghavachari had raised Rs 50,000 in Salem.[68]

By the first week of July, S.D. Krishna Aiyangar had made arrangements in Colombo for resuming the disrupted coastal service. The steamers had been insured in London and a reply telegram was awaited before the steamer could leave for Kakinada.[69] There were further reports that the *Lawoe* was leaving Colombo for Kakinada in late June 1909.[70] On 10 July, K.R. Venkatarama Aiyar sent a telegram to the *Lawoe*'s captain to start for Calcutta, while S.D. Krishna Aiyangar himself proceeded to Calcutta to receive her.[71] However, the *Lawoe*'s departure from Colombo was delayed